

teamwork is possible in a situation, and if so, the players involved make rolls for their characters separately and add their successes together.

Teamwork is the best way to deal with a multitude of adversities — bringing an angry troll to his knees, practicing an elaborate, multi-faceted heist, or singing in perfect harmony in a contest against a band of rowdy satyrs, for instance. It can also detract in situations requiring finesse and subtlety, as determined by the Storyteller. Remember that an increased number of dice being rolled also increases the number of chances for a botch to ruin the whole attempt. Sometimes too many changelings spoil the broth.

Time

Your chronicle does not need to follow every second of a changeling's life. A game session can span four weeks of in-game time as easily as it can span four hours or four days. In scenes where actions are taking place, divide time into turns to allow each participant a chance to act. The length of time these turns take is malleable.

To help maintain a general sense of the passage of time, **Changeling** uses six basic units to describe game time:

- ☉ Turn — The amount of time taken to accomplish a fairly simple action. This ranges anywhere from three seconds to three minutes, depending on the pace of the scene.
- ☉ Scene — As with the segmentation of plays and movies, a scene is a compact period of action taking place in one location during a contiguous period of time. This could be a raid on an Unseelie freehold, or a single session with a therapist. There's no restriction on the number of turns in a scene, as while a conflict likely requires dice rolling, a simple conversation might not. Notably, turn length in one scene may differ in the next scene. A battle might have a blur of swift turns, while a gripping pursuit through a crowded location may be slower at first, but with a burst of short turns at the end as the quarry coins onto their being followed and attempts an escape.
- ☉ Chapter — An independent part of a larger story, like a chapter in a book or act in a play, played out in one game session. It consists of any number of scenes interconnected by downtime.
- ☉ Story — A full story, with introduction, rising action, setbacks, and climax. Some stories can be concluded in one chapter, while others take several chapters to complete.
- ☉ Chronicle — A series of stories, connected by the characters and related structures (such as a motley or oathcircle), featuring an ongoing narrative with a common theme or overarching plot.
- ☉ Downtime — Time described rather than played out turn by turn is downtime. In scenarios where characters are waiting, recovering from injury, or taking some other sedentary action, the Storyteller can invoke downtime to bypass the interval. Good utilization of downtime greatly helps the pacing of a chronicle. Downtime allows passages of time that don't need

to be played out to be missed. Players may conduct simple, unchallenged activities during downtime — “You stop by to tell your Kinain family you love them, before your expedition to the Red Plains.” A situation beginning as downtime might become a new story if the players decide to latch on to a point raised in downtime and explore it further.

Examples of Rolls

The Storyteller rules system is designed with flexibility in mind, there being a large number of Traits, especially among Abilities. The combination of Attributes and Abilities — not discounting Backgrounds, Glamour, and Banality, where appropriate — you combine to cause a certain effect or overcome a particular ordeal is typically up to the Storyteller to dictate. Feel free to make a counter-proposal when you think of a more appropriate Trait to use for an action. Use your character in interesting, diverse ways, and you'll have more fun with the dots on your sheet.

The following examples of rolls are meant to give you some idea of the possibilities that might come up in a game:

- ☉ You're in a barely-lit part of the freehold at night, and you're trying to work out the best route to avoid potential ambushes. Roll Wits + Survival (difficulty 7).
- ☉ Instead of engaging your would-be muggers, you decide to use the shadows in the area to sneak by. Roll Dexterity + Stealth (difficulty of the lead mugger's Perception + Alertness).
- ☉ You're cornered by a severe looking redcap who threatens you with a cruel smile, resulting in an extended stare down. Roll Stamina + Intimidation (difficulty 6), resisted by the redcap's Stamina + Intimidation; each of your successes subtracts one success from the redcap's roll, and vice versa. The first to accumulate three successes wins the glowering contest.
- ☉ Standing strong, you attempt to convince your aggressor that due to your reputation and rank, it wouldn't be in his best interests to stop you. Roll Charisma + Expression (difficulty of the aggressor's Willpower).
- ☉ Finding the gunsmith's is locked up, and possessing no real lockpicking prowess, you decide to break the door open where the lock should be. Roll Strength + Larceny (difficulty 8).
- ☉ You're rummaging through the absent nocker's cluttered workshop, trying to find the silver bullets he bragged to you about making. Roll Wits + Investigation (difficulty 7).
- ☉ A cupboard you open unleashes a small, playful chimera. You assess whether the teasing entity is truly sentient, as if so it may hold some clue as to the location of the silver bullets. Roll Perception + Gremayre (difficulty 6) if talking to it in its language, or Perception + Kenning (difficulty equals the chimera's Glamour) if assessing through observation only.
- ☉ The chimera guides you to one of the nocker's treasures; an arcane, frankly bizarre looking firearm that invites you to work out its mechanisms. Roll Intelligence + Crafts (difficulty 8).
- ☉ The temptation to test the firearm on the firing range at the back of the shop is too much, so you take aim and fire a few shots from the device. Roll Dexterity + Firearms (difficulty